

clurichaun

"And there we were, me with a steak on my eye and Lady Marisol with an ice pack on her lip, and the pack of redcaps at the back of the room were — oh, you've heard this before? Well, I'll tell it again for the folks in the back, as there's a lesson in this one."

The story of the leprechauns — little green-clad fairy folk hoarding gold at the end of the rainbow — comes from mortals' distorted tales of the clurichaun. Some kiths pity the clurichaun, seeing them as victims of hundreds of years of bad PR, but others suspect that's exactly how the clurichaun want it, seeing it as a tremendous joke they're playing.

Clurichaun live primarily in Ireland, though they also traveled to the United States along with Irish immigrants, making

new homes in cities like Boston and New York City. Whether in Ireland or abroad, clurichaun share a love of music, both listening and playing. Most clurichaun play at least one instrument, and many possess the famous Irish tenor voice as well.

They enjoy telling stories through song, though they'll also spin a tale in prose. These jacks-of-all-trades are equally comfortable as bards, comedians, and oral historians, and have a certain dash of the Irish blarney. They don't lie outright, but they do love to tell a tall tale, often embellishing the story for the sake of humor or to build excitement. Their natural knack for reading a room lets them know which little details or changes would best entertain, which gives clurichaun a reputation of never telling the same story twice.

Along with storytelling, clurichaun love a good-natured brawl, and believe a fistfight can be an avenue to fast friendship. A

good donnybrook clears the air, breaks the tension, and reveals hidden passions and personality traits. Trust a clurichaun to know exactly what to say to get the most reserved sluagh or dignified sidhe to throw a punch, but also trust that when the dust clears, the clurichaun will be there with a hearty pat on the back, a stiff drink, and a clever joke to lift the spirits of those she's just incited to fisticuffs. Should a friendly fracas escalate to real violence, clurichaun have a knack for disappearing before they have to answer for any property damage or missing teeth.

More than anything, even music, stories, and fighting, clurichaun love their collections. Each clurichaun has at least one item he hoards and cherishes above everything else, the basis of the mythical pot of gold. Some clurichaun collect vinyl albums or porcelain statuettes, while others might have more expensive tastes, pursuing all the works of a particular artist or searching for rare stamps or coins. Clurichaun go to great lengths, even great personal risk in some cases, to add another item to their collection. They remember every detail of how they acquired each of their treasures, too, and gladly tell those stories to revisit the fond memories of prior adventures.

Appearance: While certainly taller than the tiny leprechauns of Irish folktales, clurichaun tend towards shorter stature, rarely topping 5' 5". Clurichaun are stocky and compact, with a solid build hinting at their strength and reliability. Their delicately-pointed ears are less noticeable than those of the sidhe. Clurichaun typically have red or russet hair, regardless of their skin tone, and bright, twinkling eyes with upturned corners, typically blue, green, or light hazel in color. Clurichaun walk with a spring in their step, and often wear conspiratorial smiles that make others feel like they're all sharing a joke. They frequently sport a black eye, busted knuckles, or other evidence of one of their friendly little scuffles.

The little green coats and buckled shoes of cartoon leprechauns don't usually crop up in their wardrobes, but clurichaun do trend toward shades of green in their clothing choices, as well as grays and browns that allow them to blend in with natural surroundings. Clurichaun demonstrate practicality in their dress, with a preference towards the functional and durable. They prefer clothing that lets them move freely and comfortably, with nothing encumbering to slow them down. Crafting aprons, work coveralls, jeans, and sturdy shoes all find their place in the clurichaun wardrobe, and they usually carry a small first aid kit, or at least a few plastic bandages and a tube of ointment.

Lifestyles: Some clurichaun prefer a nomadic life, traveling with other musicians or craftsmen to various fairs and music festivals. Other prefer a more stable home, as long as they're within walking distance of a pub or bar, preferably one with live music. Whether they live in

